

Course Progression Policy

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Contents

Purpose 2
Scope 2
Definitions 2
Principles 2
Compliance Commitments 3
TIIS Responsibilities 3
Student Responsibilities 3
Academic Progress Procedure Overview 4
Intervention Strategies 4
Show Cause and Exclusion Process 5
Monitoring and Reporting 5
Related Policies and Procedures 5
Policy Review 6
Version History 6
Appendix A: Academic Progress Monitoring and Action Procedure (Study Block Delivery Mode) 7
1. Purpose 7
2. Framework Overview 7
3. Monitoring Triggers and Academic Progress Evaluation 7
4. Risk Level Classifications and Actions 7
5. Monitoring Cadence in Study Block Model 8
6. International Student Visa Compliance 9
7. Reporting and Governance 9
8. Roles and Responsibilities (Study Block Delivery Context) 9

Purpose

This policy provides a structured framework for monitoring, supporting, and managing student academic progress at TIIS. It ensures early identification and intervention for students who may be at risk of unsatisfactory progress and outlines consequences for continued underperformance, including potential exclusion or enrolment cancellation. The framework complies with:

- HESF 2021, particularly Standard 1.3 (Orientation and Progression) and 1.4 (Learning Outcomes and Assessment)
- ESOS Act 2000, including National Code 2018 Standards 8 (Overseas Student Progress and Completion) and 10 (Complaints and Appeals)

The policy supports continuous improvement by using progression data to inform academic quality reviews and learning design in line with the Higher Education Learning Framework (HELF). *Detailed processes for Study Block Delivery Mode are located in Appendix A, which is referenced throughout the policy where relevant*

Scope

This policy applies to all coursework students enrolled in TIIS programs, regardless of delivery mode, including both Semester-based and Study Block delivery. Procedures for monitoring and intervention are outlined in detail for Study Block Delivery in Appendix A, with relevant summaries in the main body of the policy. Academic progression of students enrolled in Higher Degree by Research (HDR) programs is governed by the HDR Policy and Procedure.

Definitions

- Risk Level: A tiered classification (Levels 0–3) used to identify student academic performance and corresponding interventions.
- Show Cause Letter: A formal notice requiring the student to provide justification for continued enrolment despite unsatisfactory progress.
- Standard Full-time and Part-time Duration: The normative duration for course completion under each study load.
- Maximum Course Duration: The longest allowable period to complete a course, beyond which enrolment may be cancelled.

Principles

- TIIS is committed to academic excellence, early intervention, and tailored support for students at risk of unsatisfactory academic progress.
- Students are expected to maintain satisfactory progress by engaging in learning, passing subjects, and meeting course timelines.
- Staff and students share responsibility for academic success, supported by transparent institutional processes and evidence-based decision-making consistent with HESF 1.3.6.
- Academic progression procedures, including Risk Levels and intervention strategies, are applied consistently across Semester and Block Modes. Block Mode delivery is explicitly referenced throughout this policy, and detailed procedures are described in Appendix A.
- Students are entitled to procedural fairness, including access to support services, opportunities to respond to academic concerns, and appeal rights.

- Academic progress procedures shall be applied consistently, with clear documentation and monitoring mechanisms.
- Academic progression data will be used to inform teaching quality reviews, course design, and institutional learning analytics in accordance with the HELF principles of student-centred, reflective, and evidence-informed learning.

Compliance Commitments

This policy contributes to compliance under HESF Standard 6.3.2, which requires systematic monitoring and reporting of student progress and outcomes to inform academic quality assurance and risk management.

- HESF 1.3.5–1.3.6: TIIS supports progression through structured interventions and learning support.
- National Code Standard 8: TIIS implements documented policies and procedures for monitoring academic progress, ensuring that overseas students complete their course within the expected duration, and records variations appropriately.
- Compliance with international student visa requirements, including mandatory PRISMS reporting and course duration monitoring, applies to all students holding subclass 500 visas, irrespective of their enrolment in Semester-based or Block Mode programs. Visa compliance procedures are integrated into intervention strategies for both delivery modes.
- National Code Standard 10: TIIS ensures students are informed of their right to appeal decisions and maintains an internal and external complaints and appeals process.

TIIS Responsibilities

TIIS will ensure systematic monitoring of student academic progress, application of timely interventions, and maintenance of accurate and secure academic records. Institutional responsibilities include:

- Track your progress throughout each study block and apply support measures when needed through our Risk Level framework.
- Clearly communicate what is expected of you academically, while providing access to a wide range of academic and personal support services.
- Keep accurate records of your enrolment, progress, and any interventions or support plans.
- Report any changes to your enrolment or course duration to the Department of Home Affairs through PRISMS, where applicable.
- If your progress becomes critical, TIIS will apply the Show Cause process fairly and ensure you have access to a clear and transparent appeal pathway.
- Ensure that monitoring outcomes are reported to governance bodies (Academic Board and EMC) to inform academic quality assurance, consistent with HESF 6.3.2.

Student Responsibilities

As a TIIS student, you are expected to:

- Participate actively in your learning and work toward meeting your course requirements.
- Maintain satisfactory academic progress, and where interventions are applied, follow the conditions set to help you get back on track.

- Always keep your contact information up to date and respond promptly to communications from TIIS staff.
- Reach out for help early, whether for academic, wellbeing, or personal challenges, to ensure you access available support in a timely manner.
- Students are responsible for engaging with all support mechanisms provided under this policy and for maintaining academic integrity as a key element of satisfactory progress.

Academic Progress Procedure Overview

TIIS uses a staged approach through Risk Levels 0–3 to identify and respond to student academic performance.

Risk Level	Criteria	Institutional Action
Level 0	Satisfactory progress	Continue as normal
Level 1	Early signs of poor engagement or progress	Offer student support services, academic advice
Level 2	Multiple subject failures, poor pass rate (<50%)	Letter of concern, mandatory support, possible enrolment modification
Level 3	Continued poor performance or exceeding max duration	Show Cause issued, potential exclusion or course cancellation

Intervention Strategies

At The Institute of International Studies (TIIS), we are committed to supporting students in achieving their academic goals. Where students demonstrate signs of unsatisfactory progress, TIIS applies a tiered intervention strategy based on identified Risk Levels (1 to 3). These strategies are designed to respond early and appropriately to academic challenges, considering individual student needs and circumstances.

TIIS offers a range of targeted academic and personal support services, including:

- Study skills workshops to improve time management, assessment preparation, and independent learning strategies
- Academic advising and mentoring to guide subject planning and address progress concerns
- English language support for students who require additional development in written and spoken communication
- Mental health and wellbeing services, ensuring students have access to counselling or referrals for personal challenges
- Modified study loads or subject selection, where appropriate, to reduce cognitive and workload stress
- Each intervention will be documented in the Student Management System and linked to a corresponding Risk Level classification to ensure auditable evidence for TEQSA and ESOS compliance.

For international students, all interventions are managed in accordance with the National Code of Practice 2018 (Standard 8.16–8.17). Any approved reduced study loads must comply with visa conditions, and extensions to the expected course duration will be reported via PRISMS to the Department of Home Affairs. TIIS ensures students are informed of any visa implications and encouraged to seek migration advice when needed.

Intervention strategies will be reviewed annually for effectiveness and alignment with learning and teaching practices under TIIS's Academic Quality and Standards Framework.

Show Cause and Exclusion Process

TIIS maintains a structured and transparent process for managing students who continue to demonstrate unsatisfactory academic progress despite prior interventions. When a student reaches Risk Level 3, they are formally notified of their status and provided with an opportunity to respond.

- A Show Cause Letter will be issued by the Registrar, outlining the reasons for potential exclusion or cancellation of enrolment and inviting the student to submit a Show Cause Response within 10 business days.
- The Registrar will review the response and make a decision within 10 business days of receiving the student's submission.
- Where a student disagrees with the outcome, they have access to TIIS's Student Complaints, Grievances and Appeals Policy, which provides a fair and structured process for internal review and, if necessary, external escalation.

Students who are excluded due to unsatisfactory progress may reapply for re-admission after a minimum period of six (6) months, subject to conditions determined by TIIS. Re-admitted students will be expected to meet all academic requirements and may be subject to further progress monitoring.

Monitoring and Reporting

TIIS is committed to a culture of continuous improvement and regulatory compliance through active oversight of student academic performance and institutional processes.

The following areas are regularly monitored and reviewed:

- Individual and cohort academic performance to identify at-risk students early
- Effectiveness of intervention strategies applied at each Risk Level
- Progression trends and Risk Level distribution to support targeted improvements in learning and teaching
- Compliance with ESOS and National Code requirements for international students, including confirmation of enrolment (COE) variations and visa condition adherence
- Student academic progress is monitored using defined triggers applicable across all delivery modes. Triggers, such as repeated subject failure, low engagement, or pass rate below 50%, prompt tailored intervention actions documented under both Semester and Block Mode procedures. See Appendix A for study block-specific trigger details.
- Quarterly progression analytics will be reviewed by the Academic Board to identify systemic risks, teaching issues, and opportunities for course enhancement, with outcomes recorded in institutional quality reports.

Reports generated from these monitoring activities are submitted to the Academic Board, Executive Management Committee (EMC), and, where necessary, the Board of Directors, to inform strategic decisions and ensure accountability across governance levels.

Related Policies and Procedures

- Student Support Policy and Procedure
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Assessment Policy and Procedure
- Student Complaints, Grievances and Appeals Policy
- Higher Degree by Research Policy

- Refund Policy and Procedure
- Enrolment and Deferral Procedure
- Retention and Progression Strategy

Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed every three years or earlier if required due to changes in regulatory requirements or TIIS priorities. The policy review process will include analysis of student progression outcomes, intervention effectiveness, and compliance findings, ensuring iterative improvement consistent with HESF 6.3.3.

Version History

Policy title	Course Progression Policy
Current version	2.0
Policy Sponsor or Owner	CEO, Academic Dean or delegate
Endorsement Bodies	Board of Directors
Date of approval	27 January 2026
Implementation Date	
Date of next review	

Version	Approved by	Approval Date	Details
1.0	Academic Board	24 March 2016	Policy Name: Policy and Procedures – Student Progression and Exclusion
1.1	Board of Directors	16 June 2017	
1.2	Academic Board	24 March 2021	Minor changes
1.3	Dean	20 October 2021	Minor changes
1.4	Academic Board	03 March 2022	Minor changes
1.5	Academic Board	09 March 2022	Intervention procedure transferred ownership from EMC to Dean and included as appendix in this policy
1.6	Academic Board (Chair)	18 May 2022	Minor changes
1.7	Academic Board (Chair)	19 December 2022	Minor changes
1.8	Academic Board	7 December 2023	(1) Updated the progression and exclusion process, moved the procedure from Appendix A to main body of this policy; (2) added a flowchart to demonstrate the progression and exclusion process as Appendix A; and (3) minor editing/corrected inconsistencies.
2.0	Academic Board	27 January 2026	Policy Name: Course Progression Policy

**********END OF POLICY and PROCEDURE*********

Appendix A: Academic Progress Monitoring and Action Procedure (Study Block Delivery Mode)

1. Purpose

To ensure a consistent and transparent method of monitoring, identifying, and managing students' academic progress, including early detection of academic risk, timely intervention, and the fair and equitable application of consequences for unsatisfactory academic performance within the study block delivery model.

2. Framework Overview

TIIS applies a four-tiered Risk Level framework (Levels 0 to 3) to monitor students' academic progress across all study blocks during their enrolment. Each level is defined by academic criteria, triggers specific actions, and aligns with tailored support services and governance processes.

3. Monitoring Triggers and Academic Progress Evaluation

Monitoring occurs:

- Continuously throughout each study block via participation, assessment submission, and academic engagement
- At the end of each study block, based on final results and subject completions
- During mid-block check-ins by Academic Advisors and Student Services
- Post-census date for each study block to determine confirmed enrolments and eligibility for formal academic progress review
- Academic progress monitoring outcomes are systematically evaluated each teaching period, and findings are used to inform course-level enhancement and academic staff professional development

Criteria Reviewed:

- Repeated failures of the same subject
- Minimum pass rate (<50%)
- Extended duration of course
- Academic disengagement (non-submissions, lack of attendance or portal access)
- Medical/compassionate deferral patterns
- High frequency of withdrawals

4. Risk Level Classifications and Actions

Risk Level 0 – Satisfactory Progress

- **Criteria**:
  - Pass rate ≥ 50% of subjects completed in study blocks
  - Successful completion of units within standard block-based course durations
  - Demonstrated academic engagement
- **Actions**:
  - No intervention required
  - Monitoring continues
  - Student encouraged to maintain current progress

Risk Level 1 – Early Signs of Risk

- **Triggers**:
  - Low LMS engagement during the study block
  - Non-submission of first assessment in a subject
  - Failure in a single subject
- **Actions**:
  - Email notification with concern flagged
  - Early intervention session scheduled
  - Referral to support services (academic skills, wellbeing, etc.)
  - Recorded in SMS under "Risk Level 1"

Risk Level 2 – At Risk

- **Triggers**:
  - Two or more failed subjects across consecutive study blocks
  - Pass rate below 50% after 4 subjects attempted
  - Repeated failure of the same subject twice
  - Progressing beyond standard part-time duration without completion
- **Actions**:
  - Formal “At Risk” notification issued
  - Mandatory Academic Progress Support Meeting
  - Formal Intervention Plan created (e.g., study load reduction, support services)
  - Conditions applied to next study block enrolment
  - Visa compliance advice provided if study duration affected

Risk Level 3 – Critical Risk

- **Triggers**:
  - Third or subsequent failure of a subject
  - Ongoing <50% pass rate despite Level 2 interventions
  - Inability to complete course within maximum duration
  - Failure to comply with intervention plans

- **Actions**:
  - Show Cause Letter issued by Registrar
  - Student given 10 business days to respond
  - Decision outcomes include:
    - Enrolment with strict conditions
    - Transition to lower AQF-level course
    - Exclusion for at least 6 months
    - Cancellation of enrolment

5. Monitoring Cadence in Study Block Model

Stage	Timing	Responsible Officer	Action
Early Identification	Weeks 1–2 of Study Block	Academic Coordinators	Engagement monitoring (LMS, attendance)

Mid-Block Review	Week 3	Student Success Officer	Check on assessment submissions and participation
End of Study Block	Post results release	Registrar and Academic Dean	Formal review of Risk Levels and decisions on progression

6. International Student Visa Compliance

For students under subclass 500 visas:

- Any changes in enrolment or progression due to intervention strategies are reported to PRISMS.
- Affected students receive formal letters explaining:
  - Adjusted COE duration
  - Need to seek visa advice
- Responsibility to contact Department of Home Affairs rests with the student.

7. Reporting and Governance

- Bi-Monthly academic progress reports to the Academic Board
- PRISMS notifications managed in compliance with ESOS Act/National Code
- Data used for continuous improvement under TIIS Retention and Progression Strategy

8. Roles and Responsibilities (Study Block Delivery Context)

Role	Responsibility
Academic Dean	Oversight of policy implementation, strategic progress review
Registrar	Management of show cause process, course duration monitoring, PRISMS reporting
Student Success Officers	Coordination of support services, implementation of Intervention Plans
Subject Coordinators	Flagging early risk and supporting teaching-based intervention
Student Services Team	Student communication and engagement support, visa-related notifications